

Cynthia Hogue

The Sibyl

...man's genius is one of lies.
after Nietzsche

Presume
mirrored
reflection.

Vastly you
do not thyself
know:

& don't believe
me am I
right?

To seek the source,
that steep alley of
stone,

to make the long
climb to thatched hut to find what's
what,

to encounter
reality's
prism:

a window of light, corner of fire,
the crone's
inscrutable

smile when you fill
the door with your big Western
boots.

[cont. stanza break]

[“The Sibyl” concluded]

Don’t mistake her
trembling for
welcome

though it’s fruitful to have everything
afraid of
you:

So accidental
an Occidental insight you think it has no
consequence

you forgive gaffs,
those verbal arrows of unerring
erring

that violate reason in
language hiding
intent,

having long lost the capacity
for perception of anyone else’s individual
will,

but consider the poor
overlooked
conscience

is a trait which you have
observed humans occasionally to
use.

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